



7-Day Somatic Safety & Regulation Practice

*A gentle seven-day practice for cultivating safety, grounding,
and nervous-system regulation*

Created by

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About This Practice

Creator's Note

This workbook can be used by therapists as a general resource with clients, or by individuals as a gentle guide for self-regulation.

I created this workbook keeping in mind people who may come with severe trauma, anxiety and depression. The practices are intentionally gentle and choice-based, combining somatic awareness with selected ancient yogic breathing practices that may support calming and regulating the nervous system.

This seven-day practice was created as a gentle introduction to somatic awareness, safety and nervous-system regulation. The intention is not to force the body to relax, but to help it gradually experience the possibility of being safe enough to notice, feel and respond.

The practices are intentionally simple. Each day invites you to slow down, orient to the present moment and build a more supportive relationship with your body.

Why This Workbook Was Created

Many people understand safety intellectually while their bodies continue to respond as though something is wrong. Somatic practice can create small, repeatable experiences of grounding, choice and connection. Over time, these experiences may help the body become more familiar with regulation.

How to Use It

- Set aside a quiet 10–20 minutes each day.
- Move slowly and stay within a comfortable range.
- There is no need to perform the exercises perfectly.
- Notice sensations without judging or analysing them.
- If an exercise feels too intense, pause, open your eyes, orient to the room and return to a neutral activity.
- Finish each practice with the reflection questions and affirmation.

A Note on Safety

This workbook is for gentle well-being and self-awareness practice. It is not a substitute for medical or mental-health care.



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The Theme of Week One

Safety and regulation: teaching the body, gently and repeatedly, “I’m safe enough to notice.”



Day 1: Finding Safety & Orienting

Intention: Begin by noticing the present moment and allowing the body to register signs of safety.

Breath Practice

2–3 Minute Breath Practice: Diaphragmatic Breathing

Sit or lie comfortably. Place one hand on your belly and one on your chest. Breathe gently through the nose and allow the belly to rise naturally on the inhale and soften on the exhale. Do not force the breath or take very deep breaths. Continue for 2–3 minutes, keeping the breath quiet, easy and comfortable.

Practice

1. Orienting to the Room — 3 minutes

Sit comfortably. Let your eyes move slowly around the room. Notice colours, shapes, light, doors, windows and objects that feel neutral or pleasant. Let your head turn gently rather than forcing your gaze.

2. Hand on Heart & Belly — 3 minutes

Place one hand over your heart and one over your belly. Do not force the breath. Simply notice the movement beneath your hands. Allow your shoulders and jaw to soften by a small amount.

3. Gentle Body Scan — 5 minutes

Bring attention slowly from your feet upward. Notice contact, temperature, pressure, tension or ease. You do not need to change anything. The practice is simply to notice.

4. Closing Pause — 1 minute

Look around once more and identify one thing in the room that tells your body, "I am here, right now."

Reflection

- What did my body notice first when I slowed down?
- Where did I experience even a small sense of ease or neutrality?
- What helped me feel more present today?

Daily Affirmation

"I can slow down and notice the safety that is available to me."



Day 2: Physiological Sigh & 5–4–3–2–1 Grounding

Intention: Use breath and the senses to gently shift attention away from overwhelm and toward the present.

Breath Practice

2–3 Minute Breath Practice: Physiological Sigh

Take a comfortable inhale through the nose, then add a second, smaller inhale at the top. Follow with a long, relaxed exhale through the mouth. Repeat gently for about 2–3 minutes, then return to your natural breathing. If you feel light-headed or uncomfortable, stop and breathe normally.

Practice

1. Physiological Sigh — 3 minutes

Take a comfortable inhale through the nose. Add a second, smaller inhale at the top. Then make a long, easy exhale through the mouth. Repeat gently for several rounds without straining.

2. Pause & Notice — 2 minutes

Return to your natural breathing. Notice the sensations of breathing without trying to control them.

3. 5–4–3–2–1 Sensory Grounding — 5 minutes

Notice 5 things you can see, 4 things you can physically feel, 3 things you can hear, 2 things you can smell, and 1 thing you can taste or imagine tasting.

4. Closing Orientation — 1 minute

Name the day, where you are and one thing you will do next.

Reflection

- What changed in my body after the breathing practice?
- Which sense was easiest for me to connect with?
- Did orienting to the present moment change my sense of safety?

Daily Affirmation

"I can return to the present, one breath and one sense at a time."



Day 3: Pendulation — Moving Between Comfort & Neutrality

Intention: Learn that you can gently move attention between a comfortable sensation and a neutral area without becoming stuck in either.

Breath Practice

2–3 Minute Breath Practice: Extended Exhalation — 4:6 Breathing

Inhale gently through the nose for a count of 4. Exhale slowly and comfortably for a count of 6. Continue for 2–3 minutes. Keep the breath relaxed; the counts should never feel forced or leave you short of breath.

Practice

1. Find a Neutral or Pleasant Sensation — 3 minutes

Notice one area that feels neutral, warm, supported or comfortable. It might be your hands, feet, back against a chair or the sensation of clothing.

2. Notice a Neutral/Uncomfortable Area — 1 minute

Briefly notice another area that feels tense, heavy or simply different. Do not investigate it deeply.

3. Pendulate — 5 minutes

Move attention slowly back to the more comfortable or neutral area. Stay for several breaths. Then briefly notice the other area and return again to comfort or neutrality. Continue at your own pace.

4. Closing Grounding — 2 minutes

Feel the support beneath you. Look around the room. Take one natural breath and notice that you have choice about where your attention goes.

Reflection

- What was it like to move my attention rather than stay with one sensation?
- Which sensation felt easiest to return to?
- What did I learn about having choice with my attention?

Daily Affirmation

"I can move gently between sensations and return to what feels supportive."



Day 4: Grounding Through the Feet

Intention: Use the feet and contact with the ground as a simple anchor for stability and present-moment awareness.

Breath Practice

2–3 Minute Breath Practice: Grounding Breath — 4:6

Bring your attention to your feet and the support beneath you. Inhale gently through the nose for a count of 4, then exhale slowly for a count of 6. Continue for 2–3 minutes while noticing your feet and the ground. If counting feels uncomfortable, return to natural breathing.

Practice

1. Feel the Feet — 2 minutes

Sit or stand comfortably. Notice the soles of your feet, their temperature and the points of contact with the floor.

2. Gentle Weight Shift — 3 minutes

If standing feels comfortable, slowly shift a small amount of weight from one foot to the other. Keep the movement easy and within your balance.

3. Press & Release — 3 minutes

Gently press your feet into the floor for a few seconds, then release. Notice the difference between effort and release. Repeat several times.

4. Grounded Standing or Seated Pause — 3 minutes

Let the floor carry some of your weight. Notice your legs, pelvis and spine. Allow yourself to be supported rather than holding yourself rigidly.

Reflection

- What sensations did I notice in my feet and legs?
- Did pressing into the ground change how supported I felt?
- What does groundedness mean to me today?

Daily Affirmation

"The ground is beneath me, and I am allowed to receive its support."



Day 5: Self-Holding & Containment

Intention: Introduce gentle, choice-based touch as a way of communicating support and boundaries to the body.

Breath Practice

2–3 Minute Breath Practice: Three-Part Yogic Breath

Begin with a soft inhale. First allow the belly to expand, then the lower ribs to widen, and finally allow a small amount of expansion into the upper chest. Exhale gently, allowing the upper chest, ribs and belly to soften in sequence. Keep the breath smooth rather than maximal. Continue for 2–3 minutes.

Practice

1. Hand-to-Arm Hold — 3 minutes

Place one hand gently around the opposite forearm or upper arm. Hold with comfortable pressure. Switch sides when ready.

2. Hand on Chest & Belly — 3 minutes

Place one hand on the chest and one on the belly, or choose another placement that feels supportive. Notice warmth, pressure and contact.

3. Self-Containment — 3 minutes

Wrap your arms around yourself in a light, comfortable hold. There is no need to squeeze. Let the hold communicate, "I am here with myself."

4. Release Slowly — 1 minute

Let your hands move away gradually. Notice the difference between being held and being free to move.

Reflection

- Which type of touch felt most supportive?
- How did my body respond to being gently held?
- What kind of support do I need more of right now?

Daily Affirmation

"I can offer myself support, comfort and choice."



Day 6: Jaw & Face Release — Humming and Gentle Yawns

Intention: Invite softness into the face, jaw and throat while using sound and gentle movement to support regulation.

Breath Practice

2–3 Minute Breath Practice: Bhramari (Bumblebee Breath)

Sit comfortably with the spine supported and relaxed. Take a gentle inhale through the nose. As you exhale, keep the lips softly closed and make a low, smooth humming sound like a bumblebee. Notice the gentle vibration around the lips, face and throat. Repeat for 5–7 comfortable rounds. Do not strain or make the sound excessively loud. After the final round, sit quietly for a few breaths and notice the effect.

Practice

1. Face Awareness — 2 minutes

Notice your forehead, eyes, cheeks, jaw, tongue and lips. Do not try to relax them immediately; simply notice.

2. Gentle Jaw Release — 2 minutes

Let your teeth separate slightly. Allow the jaw to hang softly. Make very small side-to-side movements if comfortable.

3. Gentle Yawn — 2 minutes

Allow a natural or simulated gentle yawn. Keep the movement small and comfortable. Let the mouth close softly afterward.

4. Humming — 3 minutes

Take a comfortable breath and hum softly on the exhale. Notice the vibration around the lips, face and throat. Repeat several times.

5. Closing Pause — 1 minute

Notice your face, jaw, throat and breath. Let the body decide whether it wants more movement or stillness.

Reflection

- Where did I notice the most tension in my face or jaw?
- What did the humming or gentle yawn feel like in my body?
- What changed when I allowed my face to soften?

Daily Affirmation

"I can soften without forcing. My body is allowed to find its own pace."



Day 7: Integration & Journaling

Intention: Bring the week's practices together and notice what your body has learned about safety, choice and regulation.

Breath Practice

2–3 Minute Breath Practice: Box Breathing — 4:4:4:4

Inhale gently through the nose for a count of 4. Hold comfortably for a count of 4. Exhale gently for a count of 4. Hold with the lungs comfortably empty for a count of 4. Repeat for 5 rounds. Keep every phase soft and comfortable. If breath retention creates anxiety, dizziness or discomfort, stop the counting and return to natural breathing.

Practice

1. Orienting — 2 minutes

Look around the room slowly. Notice where you are and identify three things that feel neutral or pleasant.

2. Grounding — 2 minutes

Feel the support beneath your body or feet. Let your attention rest there for several breaths.

3. Choose Your Most Supportive Practice — 5 minutes

Repeat one practice from the week that felt grounding or regulating. You may choose orienting, breath, pendulation, feet, self-holding, humming or another practice that felt supportive.

4. Whole-Body Check-In — 3 minutes

Notice your body from head to feet. Ask: What is here now? What feels different from Day 1? There is nothing you need to fix.

5. Journaling — 5 minutes

Write freely about your week. Focus on small changes, moments of safety, sensations, preferences and anything you want to continue.

Reflection

- What have I learned about how my body experiences safety?
- Which practice would I like to continue using?
- What is one small way I can support my nervous system this week?

Daily Affirmation

"I can listen to my body with patience, compassion and choice."



Sharing This Workbook

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Created by Raheelaa Ahmad

The intention of this work is to make gentle somatic practices accessible while honouring the importance of choice, pacing and individual experience.